

Balatrodle: A Daily Balatro Guessing Game

Description

Balatrodle is a web-based daily puzzle game where players guess a hidden “joker” (a collectible item) from the deck-building video game *Balatro*. It follows the format of *Wordle* and later games like *LoLdle* and *Valdle*. There is one mystery joker each day, and it is the same puzzle for everyone. It refreshes at a set time.

To play, the user types the name of a joker. The game compares that guess to the hidden answer and gives color-coded feedback on several attributes: rarity, purchase cost, effect type, activation timing, whether the effect scales, and how the joker is unlocked. A matching attribute turns green and a partial match turns yellow. For numeric attributes like cost, an up or down arrow shows whether the real value is higher or lower. Players use these clues to narrow down the answer, which usually takes four to six guesses.

The game also tracks each player’s win streak, produces a spoiler-free grid they can share, and keeps an archive of past puzzles. Since everyone gets the same puzzle each day, players can compare their results with friends.

Users

The main users are people who play *Balatro*, plus the wider audience that likes quick daily guessing games in the *Wordle* style. The game works for dedicated fans, who can name obscure jokers from small clues, and for newer players, who learn the roster as they play. It needs no account and no installation. A user opens the page in a browser on a phone or computer and starts playing. A second group to design for is the returning player, whose streak and statistics are saved between visits even without an account.

Technology and Justification

Balatrodle is a full-stack web project. It has three separate parts: a user interface, a backend service, and a database.

The user interface will be built with React which lets me build each piece as a reusable component with its own state, which keeps the code organized as the interface grows. React is also common and well documented, and something I have experience using.

The backend will be a REST API written in Python with Flask. Python is easy to use and this project only needs a few endpoints: get the current day’s puzzle, check a submitted guess on the server, and return player statistics.

The database will be SQLite, used from Python through the built-in `sqlite3` module. A relational database fits because the data is structured and connected. There will be four tables: `jokers` holds each joker and its attributes, `daily_puzzles` links each date to that day’s answer, `users` stores anonymous player records, and `guesses` records each attempt.

SQLite works well here because it is serverless and file-based. The whole database is a single file, with no separate server to install or run.